



Reliance's 3G tablet

Reliance became the first in India to offer tablets on both 3G and CDMA with the launch of The Reliance 3G Tab

What's new in Linux Kernel 3.5

Read on to find out what the latest release of the Linux Kernel has in store for you
<http://dgit.in/P9bqfo>

SCALING

CrossFireX simply scales better than SLI, though both configurations end up taking a performance hit in some games as compared to a single GPU configuration. We do see a humungous bump in performance in OpenGL/OpenCL computation on AMD cards but NVIDIA ended up performing worse than a single GPU configuration. AMD clearly is better at computation for code that isn't specifically written for either architecture. When it comes to gaming, SLI is better than AMD in almost all of the benchmarks.



ASUS GTX 680 DC2T

FREEBIES

When a customer pays top money for a product he/she expects to get a good value for the money paid and that's quite obvious. What's puzzling is that a product that costs upwards of 35K doesn't come with a simple SLI/CrossFireX bridge/finger. The thing is that nearly all motherboards that can support SLI/CrossFireX do come with the SLI bridge and those who do end up buying multiple GPUs will always have these particular motherboards.



ASUS HD 7770 DC

As for games, there is absolutely no excuse for not including them. Last year, when we performed GPU benchmarks, we discovered about 5-6 games overall. This time we got a pack of 3 games with just one card. No other card had any games other than coupons for limited play. Given the Steam summer sale which was underway till the 22nd of July, it is quite evident that for a measly \$5 a diverse number of games are available which can be bundled along with a high end card. Being a PC gamer is getting more and more expensive by the day.

Winners ASUS GTX 680 DC2T

The GTX 680 with a mammoth 4GB memory narrowly raced past the HD 7970 DC2T to clinch the best performer award. This card which is part of the Direct CU2 series happens to be over-clocked than the stock GTX 680 by 131 MHz. The 7970, also from ASUS came second because it too is clocked 75 MHz higher than a stock card. Both cards come with improved coolers consisting of twin fans spread over 6 and 5 heat pipes for the 7970 and 680 respectively. Not to mention the solid design features which include protective metal back plates and twin fans.

Galaxy GT 640 1GB D3

The card with the best price-to-performance ratio turned out to be the 1GB GT 640 from



Galaxy GT 640 1GB D3

Galaxy. The 2GB version of the same card costing ₹600 more gave a negligible performance boost over the 1GB card, so naturally this became the best buy among the low-end line-up. The Galaxy GT 640 comes with a bigger fan and heat-sink combo and remains much cooler than the Zotac card.

ASUS 7770 DC

This card turned out to be a budget friendly card which was capable of playing even the most taxing games at playable FPS. For a price of ₹12,500 it is a decent card for the average joe. The MSI 7770 Power Edition missed out getting the best buy by a fraction of a hair mostly because of the features.

ASUS GTX 670 Direct CU2T

This card got the Best Buy in the high-end range as it sometimes equalled the GTX 680 in performance (due to its 157MHz overclock) while retailing at a cheaper price of ₹32,000. Only ₹2,000 higher than a stock 670. Also, the improved cooler design was a huge bonus.

Editor's Pick ZOTAC GTX 680

It's a stock GTX 680 priced as much as any other stock GTX 680. The difference is that this card comes with ample accessories and most importantly, 3 full games (Assassin's Creed 1, 2 and Revelations) and a 3-day coupon for TrackMania Canyon. The cooler being stock is nothing out of the ordinary but the card can easily be clocked higher and still remain within acceptable temperatures.

CONCLUSION

It seems at stock frequencies the Radeon 7970 and the NVIDIA 680 pretty much equal each other with one card being better



ASUS GTX 670 Direct CU2T

at a few games while the other for the rest. When it came to computation, the Radeon cards are ahead of the competition especially in multi-GPU configurations. The GTX



ZOTAC GTX 680

690 has no competition at the moment with the Radeon 7990 a few days away from launch (at the time of writing this article) being the only candidate. So we have benchmarked it but left it out of the scoring sheet till we receive the Radeon 7990. **d**